

Miner Diamond Opener Nears

By FLIP MORIN

Times Sports Writer

The University of Texas at El Paso's baseballers continue inter-squad workouts at Hugo Meyer Field in preparation for the 1974 exhibition opener Feb. 22-23, hosting Ranger Junior College.

Coach Andy Cohen has some high hopes for this year's Miner baseball team in his 12th season at the helm. "The team spirit and hustle is high. We have no problems in this area," Cohen said.

Coach Cohen said the daily workouts have resulted in the team's being in much better shape this far in the season than any previous year. "My brother Syd has the pitchers especially on a special physical conditioning program and it has paid off," Cohen said. "We have no worries about sore arms or other petty injuries because of the exercises they are going through."

Last year the Miners looked good in non-conference play while compiling a 16-11 won and lost slate. But when Western Athletic Conference action came it was another story and they plummeted to a 2-16 league record.

A dozen returning lettermen spark the current roster of hopefuls, presently at 29, including 15 El Pasoans. Four seniors are in their final U.T. El Paso season — infielder Bob Downing, outfielder Herb Von Hagen, catcher Jim Brundage and pitcher Mike Kruta.

Coach Cohen has given an early nod for the Ranger exhibition (2 p.m.) to a couple of moundmen. Tentatively set for pitching chores are Riverside High School's Sam Cox, a freshman at 6-foot and 155 pounds and a righthander, along with David Jannusch, another frosh from Carpentersville, Ill. Jannusch is 6-2 and 175 and also throws and bats right-handed.

Rounding out the pitching staff are El Pasoan John Franklin a sophomore; letterman sophomore Mike Hilton from Andrews, Tex.; Pampa, Texas' Jeff Hogan, a sophomore letterman; Steve Klein, a junior from Chicago plus Chicagoans Dan Modlinski and Bob Knox, both juniors.

Larry Richardson is a sophomore letterman from Odessa, Tex., Kruta, a graduating letterman is from Arlington, Tex.

Catchers include letterman Mike Miller, a sophomore.

Brundage and Joe Segapeli, a freshman. All are from El Paso.

Outfielders are Von Hagen, freshmen Terry Dillingham from Borger, Tex., and El Paso's Jim Walsh, sophomore Keith Rushing of El Paso and juniors Joe Pennies of El Paso and Roy Stringer from Prescott, Ariz. Pennies, Von Hagen and Rushing are returning lettermen.

Infielders for '74 are freshmen Jesse Castro and Fred Goss, from El Paso along with Odessa's Rick Young; sophomores Mike Sanchez from Fabens, David Patt and Glen Villarreal from El Paso; juniors Mark Miller and David Nance from El Paso; and senior Bob Downing, El Paso. Downing, Miller and Villarreal are the lettermen.

WAC play begins April 5 hosting the Arizona State Sun Devils for a two-day stand.

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